

Flattered to pieces, I went to a lot of trouble. I asked counsel from my investment counselors, and went to several other sagacious men of finance. I spent hours over what stocks to buy in the industries that seemed best for her, what percentages of her stocks to go into what industries, and so on.

She thanked me sweetly for the neatly typewritten investment program, asked a few pertinent questions about it, wrote down the name of my broker, and departed. It turned out that she didn't buy anything that I recommended.

For example, I had suggested the purchase of two oil stocks: Royal Dutch and Kerr-McGee. The broker became alarmed when she told him that I was advising her to buy Zapata Off Shore and Ambassador Oil. He thought I'd gone daft and telephoned to say so. I called Miss Elderly Snowflake (never mind about her real name) and found that on leaving me she had taken a taxi straight to her astrologist. It seems that the stars weren't sitting quite right for Royal Dutch Oil, and Kerr-McGee was no good for her *ever*—for some reason that had to do with Libra.

Furthermore, she hadn't bought any Litton Industries because she didn't like the name Litton, and she couldn't buy any Eli Lilly stock as lilies are associated with funerals and are therefore bad luck. I hung up, and every time I think of her I feel cross.

And to make me feel more cross, she now lives in Rapallo in a beautiful remodeled *castello* or *palazzo* looking down on the blue Mediterranean, and they say it has more bathrooms than any other villa south of Rome.

Maybe there is something to this astrology after all.

IMPATIENT GRISELDO

There is another quality essential to investing for yourself: Patience. In 1932, when the depression was at its lowest ebb, a friend of mine came to New York as a young man, found